

## Tools for translation

Google has a website exclusively dedicated to Indian language transliteration. On this site, [www.google.co.in/transliterate/indic/](http://www.google.co.in/transliterate/indic/), you can transliterate into five Indian languages—Hindi, Telugu, Kannada, Tamil and Malayalam. You can also easily toggle between an Indian language and English. Using this transliteration option, many blogs have come up in Indian languages. There is even an exclusive blog site (<http://blogs.co.in>) that supports eight Indian languages, which include Gurumukhi, Gujarati and Bengali, apart from the five on Google's transliteration site. Here, by just clicking one pop-up menu, you can select the desired Indian language.

C-DAC's iplug-in can be used to create webpages in Indian languages. It works on different OS like Solaris, Linux, UNIX or any other OS that supports the Java Run Time. Three different types of keyboards are available—Inscript, Typewriter and Phonetic. The URL of the website is <http://iplug.cdac.in>.

The iplug-in supports three more languages in addition to the eight languages available at [blogs.co.in](http://blogs.co.in). They are Marathi, Assamese and Oriya. So, gradually, more and more Indian languages are making their presence felt on the World Wide Web.

<http://groups.google.com/group/aksharamala> is another website that provides free downloads to create pages in Indian languages. Aksharamala is a standards-based software tool that facilitates inputting content in Indian languages, and it automatically transliterates the English characters you type to the target Indian language. This website supports the Unicode font system.

Baraha is the free Indian language software that supports Devanagari, Kannada, Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam, Gujarati, Gurumukhi, etc. It supports the Unicode-based fonts. It can be used to create documents, send e-mails and create webpages. You can freely download the software and documentation from [www.baraha.com](http://www.baraha.com).

Mantra Rajbhasha software from C-DAC can translate documents related to administration, such as office orders, circulars and memos, from English to Hindi. There are different versions of Mantra like the standalone, intranet and Internet versions. After successfully enabling translation from English to Hindi, now C-DAC is trying to use this technology to translate English to other Indian languages like Gujarati, Telugu and Bengali.

are useful for Malayalam. The Unicode font system is supported by all leading operating systems like Windows, Red Hat Linux and Mac OS X. Many other major companies like IBM, HP, SAP, Sun and Apple have adopted the Unicode standards, so one can expect support for all Indian languages, for all applications developed by these major companies, across the world.

## Government's efforts

The government of India is promoting the use of Indian languages on the Internet and on computers. The Department of Information Technology (DIT) has launched a programme called Technology Development for Indian Languages (TDIL), under which two websites were developed. On one of them, <http://ildc.gov.in>, you can find many useful downloads for In-

dian languages. If you register on this website, TDIL will send you a CD with fonts and the other necessary software required to write in Indian languages. Another website, <http://tdil.mit.gov.in>, offers information about IT terminology, IT localisation, machine-aided translation, etc.

C-DAC has been a pioneer in developing and popularising Indian languages in the information technology field. And even now, C-DAC continues in its efforts with specific focus in translation, computer-aided learning of Indian languages and office products.

## OS support

The Windows-XP operating system (OS) is available in Hindi. In this OS, right from logging-in to the control panel and even the environment, everything is in Hindi. Microsoft has

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